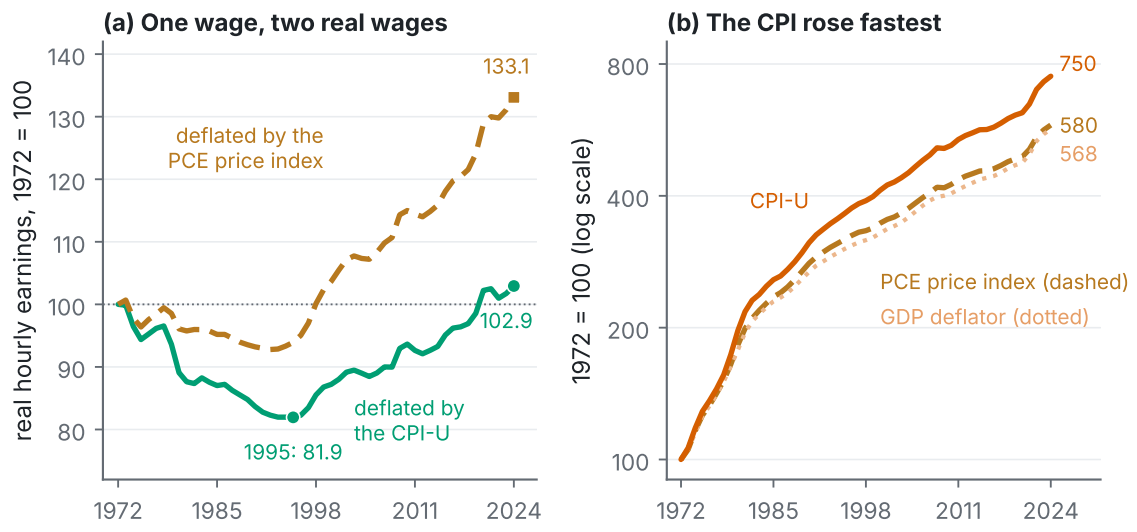
(a) One wage, two real wages
real hourly earnings, 1972 = 100
140
130
120
110
100
90
80
133.1
deflated by the
PCE price index
102.9
deflated by
the CPI-U
1995: 81.9
1972
1985
1998
2011
2024
(b) The CPI rose fastest
1972 = 100 (log scale)
800
400
200
100
750
580
568
CPI-U
PCE price index (dashed)
GDP deflator (dotted)
1972
1985
1998
2011
2024